

Emily Thao

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Academic Background

University of Wisconsin-Madison (Madison, WI)

Sept. 2022 – May 2026

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Information Science

Certificates: Game Design, Asian American Studies, and Digital Studies

Professional Experience

Atlas Arena/Nexus Games Labs, Inc (Remote)

June 2026 – Present

Game Development Intern

- Enhancing a puzzle-based game created by internship coordinators by adding mines
 - Change scoring conditions based on player movement
- Learn how to create and iterate games based on teams' goals
- Serving as an art director, programmer, and game designer in a team of 5

University of Wisconsin-Madison (Madison, WI)

Oct. 2023 – May 2025

Communications & Social Media Intern for MJLSP

- Designed 30+ assets, flyers, and IG posts for Freshman and Sophomore cohorts
- Promoted UW-Madison to 45+ students and parents at college fairs and on campus
- Most recent design work for program-wide projects including:
 - Level Up: GTA crew necks (250+ attendees)
 - Cohort stickers: stickers for each cohort year (350+ scholars)
 - Timeline project: historical record for MJLSP's 40th anniversary

Fall 2023 – Spring 2024

Fall 2023

Fall 2024 – Spring 2025

Northwestern Mutual (Milwaukee, WI)

May 2022 – Aug. 2023

Software Engineer Intern

- hi-Tech Minicamp: introduction to web development with **HTML, CSS, JS, React**
- Part-time internship: fulfilled 50+ web page updates and outlined email templates
- College Internship: **C#** search and replace program, bookmarking feature
- Practiced **scrum** skills by holding 30+ meetings, including demonstrations for stakeholders and departments

Summer 2022

Fall 2022 – Spring 2023

Summer 2023

Skills

- Programming: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Java, Python, C#, ReactJS, Three.js, React Three Fiber
- Tools: GitLab, GitHub, Microsoft Excel, Microsoft PowerPoint
- Design (Art, UI & UX, 3D): Canva, Maya, Rhino, Figma, Eloqua
- Editing: Adobe Lightroom, Adobe Premiere Rush
- Languages: English (fluent), Hmong (proficient)

Personal & Group Projects

Boba Shop – Personal Portfolio

Web Developer, UI & UX Designer, Artist

Individual Project

Fall 2025 – Spring 2026

- Software & skills: ReactJS, Vite, Three.js, React Three Fiber, Maya, Prototyping
- Developed an interactive 3D portfolio using ReactJS, Three.js, and React Three Fiber, showcasing projects through screenshots and embedded games
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Recreation of Pac-Man

Frontend Developer & User Interface Designer

Team Project

Spring 2025

- Software & skills: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Canvas API, Agile, GitLab
- Recreation of the classic arcade game, Pac-Man, using web development languages
- Designed colorful start and end screens, which increased player retention and attracted players to the game
- Refactored architecture into separate components, which highly improved maintainability and navigation
- Ideated 25+ tasks and assigned tasks to teammates

Green Forms

Usability Engineer & User Experience Designer

Team Project

Fall 2024

- Software & skills: Figma, Prototyping
- Held three usability tests with Qualtrics users to gain an understanding of its shortcomings and advantages
- Developed high-fidelity prototype of our application, Green Forms, in Figma
- Held three usability tests with new users to test new application

Recognitions & Extracurriculars

- Scholarships: Mercile J. Lee Scholarship Program (MJLSP), Dell Scholar, APIA Scholars
- Mercile J. Lee Scholarship Program – full tuition scholarship at UW-Madison
 - MJLSP Hackathon (Spring 2024 – Spring 2025)
 - Big Sibling Program (2024 – 2026): served as a mentor to MJLSP freshman
- APIA Scholars: served as a Career Development Committee member (2025 – 2026)
 - Developed portfolio resources to help students improve their professional careers
 - Presented to 50-60 students about the importance of a digital or physical portfolio
- UW Hmong Studies in Thailand (June 2025): served as a Hmong translator during homestays